

SOP-43: Ad-Account Billing Continuity

Version 1.0 · 2026-08-05 · Owner: PPC Lead · First build (no prior version) · Thresholds live in the Master PPC Decision Criteria System v4.0 only; this SOP carries zero local thresholds; every billing-specific operating number the component needs but v4.0 does not contain is logged in the Closing Amendment List, never written here as a rule.

1. Verdict and Scope

VERDICT: a billing failure on either entity ad account pauses every campaign in that account from the moment Amazon's charge attempt fails, halting up to 100% of the \$6,000-8,000/day account delivery envelope and stopping every downstream SOP in the 46-component register at once. No other single failure in the program has that blast radius, which is why the Cross-Reference Ledger marks this component the highest time criticality in the program. This SOP makes the failure preventable by a standing two-account Billing Continuity Register verified weekly, detectable within the same day by artifacts the stack already computes, and reversible the same day through a pre-authorized response path with a named escalation when the path is blocked.

This document is written 4 days after the component's own trigger event: credit-card ad billing on the legacy method ended 2026-08-01 and the component was due 2026-07-31. It therefore opens with an immediate two-account state audit (P1) rather than a pre-deadline migration plan, and it treats the 2026-08-01 change as the motivating incident class for its failure modes. The billing state found by P1 on first execution, whatever it is, becomes row 1 of the register.

1.1 Scope: what this SOP owns exclusively

Per its Ledger row, this component owns billing method continuity across both entity ad accounts (Ecotero LLC, Inspiratek LLC) and the failure response, as a standalone continuity procedure. Concretely: the Billing Continuity Register and its schema; the weekly verification pass; primary and backup payment method doctrine inside the ad consoles; billing failure detection and triage; same-day remediation; restoration verification; post-incident reconciliation including trend-exclusion flagging; payment instrument lifecycle handling (expiry, replacement, entity banking changes as they touch console registration); and the quarterly continuity drill.

1.2 Boundaries with adjacent components

Adjacent component	The seam, stated so it is owned
Criteria System v4.0 (#8)	Decides every threshold, band, and verdict in the library. v4.0 contains zero billing rules today; every operating number this SOP needs is a v4.1 amendment item (Closing list), never a number written here.
#46 Access and Permissions	Owns the billing-admin seat, its provisioning, and the Access Register. This SOP consumes the billing-admin filtered register view on demand; it never grants, changes, or audits access.
#38 Bulk-File Deployment Mechanics	Owns staging, upload, and T+1 verification. This SOP reads the T+1 report and A2 deployment state as detection evidence only; nothing here stages a campaign change.
#37 Automation Platform Rules	Owns the rule register and change control. Automation never touches billing surfaces; any proposed billing-adjacent rule routes to #37 change control, and #37's rule log is read in triage to exclude rule-driven pauses.
#3 Authority Matrix	Owns decision rights. The Matrix v2.0 carries no #43 row; interim rights in this SOP follow the Matrix standing rules (vacancy reversion) and the missing row is amendment item AM-5.
#4 Weekly and daily cadence	Owns the calendar. The weekly check (P5) lands inside the Monday cascade; a named billing slot and the quarterly drill slot are owed to #4 and #40 (AM-7).
Finance / entity officers	Own the payment instruments themselves: cards, bank accounts, credit lines, invoicing terms. This SOP operates their registration inside the ad consoles and never selects or negotiates an instrument.
#32 Deal and Event Windows	Owns event plans. An armed window multiplies the exposure of an outage (F9) but every event action belongs to #32.
#24 Re-Ranking and Recovery	Owns rank restoration. Where an outage window produced rank slippage, P9 hands the window and term list to #24 and stops at that boundary.

2. Trigger Conditions

Each trigger names its detecting artifact and its maximum allowed lag from signal to procedure start. Where v4.0 supplies a same-day rule the lag quotes it; billing-specific lag ceilings tighter than same-day do not exist in v4.0 and are amendment item AM-1, so until AM-1 lands the binding lag on every alarm-class trigger is the v4.0 same-day standard.

Trigger	Detecting artifact	Max lag to procedure start	Procedure
Weekly continuity check reached in the Monday cascade	Billing Continuity Register + both ad consoles	Within the Monday session (#4 slot)	P5
Delivery collapse: product pacing deviation past the v4.0 G7 line (deviation >25% vs the day-of-week curve)	T0 zone D gates strip / daily pacing alert (Data Architecture Section 4)	Same day, per G7 (v4.0, Section 5 "Layer 0: Gates (G1-G12). Nothing Proceeds Until These Pass")	P6
Paused campaigns not traceable to any T6 entry or #37 rule	#38 T+1 verification report; A2 deployment state (T7 manifest row)	Same day of the report	P6
Amazon billing notification (failed charge, expiring instrument, unpaid invoice)	Routed alert inbox named in the register row	Same day of receipt	P6, then P7 or P10 per content
Instrument lifecycle date approaching (card expiry month, invoice due day)	Register countdown columns, read at P5	The P5 pass in which the countdown first surfaces	P10
Org change touching the billing-admin seat	Authority Matrix re-issue; #46 weekly reconciliation diff	Within the #46 weekly reconciliation	P11 access check
Billing incident closed (charge success confirmed)	Console Payment history entry written by P7	Same day	P8, then P9

3. Preconditions and Gates

Every procedure runs only after these read current. Where an artifact is missing, the pass follows the v4.0 G8 honesty clause ("the analysis states what it could not see") and continues on direct console observation, recording the gap.

Precondition	Manifest / source ID	Observable that proves it passed
Billing-admin access live on both entity consoles	#46 Access Register, billing-admin filtered view	The operator opens the Billing page on both accounts without an access error, and the #46 view shows the seat row current. Fail: P11.
Deployment state current	A2 (T7 manifest field group, per #39 definitions)	T7 row A2 reads PRESENT with the current Monday refresh stamp. Needed for the P6 tree branch 2-4 evidence.
Decision log current and scored	T6 Decision Log (Data Architecture Section 9)	Last cycle's due rows carry V5 scores; pauses of record are findable. Needed to clear P6 branch 4.
Register at current version	Billing Continuity Register header	Header check-date equals the most recent Monday P5 stamp. Stale register: P5 runs first, then the dependent procedure.
Automation rule log readable	#37 rule register, per its Ledger row clause "the rule register, the sync check cadence, and change control"	The current export or log view opens. Absent: P6 branch 4 cannot clear and ambiguity escalates (I-5).

No billing-state manifest field group exists in the #39 definitions; the console is a manual read outside the Raw Pull Pack. That absence is amendment item AM-6, and until it lands the G8 clause governs: a pass that could not open a console says so in its stamp.

4. Step-Level Procedures

P1. Immediate two-account billing state audit (first execution; P5 maintains thereafter)

Time: 30-40 minutes for both accounts. Run once on adoption, and again after any entity-level account event.

1. Sign in to the Ecotero LLC advertising console at advertising.amazon.com using the billing-admin seat named in the #46 view. No shared or personal credentials; the seam is #46's.
2. Open the account menu (gear icon, top right), select **Billing**. Record from the Billing summary surface: current payment method type (charge card, direct debit, deduction from sales proceeds, or monthly invoicing), the identifier shown (card network and last 4, or bank last 4, or invoicing account reference), the last successful payment date and amount from **Payment history**, and any red failed-payment or unpaid-balance banner text verbatim.
3. Where the entity advertises through a seller account, also open Seller Central: **Settings > Account Info > Payment Information > Advertising Charge Methods**. Record the charge method on file and whether the account is set to deduct advertising charges from sales proceeds before charging the method. Both surfaces are recorded because the seller path and the console path can disagree after a migration, and the disagreement is exactly what P1 exists to surface.
4. Record any outstanding unpaid balance and its age from Payment history. An unpaid balance with a failed-charge banner is a live

incident: stop the audit for this account and run P7 now; resume P1 after P8.

5. Repeat steps 1-4 for the Inspiratek LLC account. The two accounts are audited separately end to end; nothing is inferred from one to the other.
6. Write one register row per account (P2 schema) and set each row's State: VERIFIED (method on file, no banner, last payment succeeded), or FAILED (banner or unpaid balance present). These state labels are register vocabulary, not verdicts from the closed vocabulary; their admission is amendment item AM-2.
7. Stamp the audit date and the executing role in the register header, and log the audit as a dated entry in the register's Incident and Check Log sheet.

P2. Build and maintain the Billing Continuity Register

Time: 45 minutes first build; 5 minutes of upkeep inside each P5 pass. Artifact definition in Element 8.

1. Create **Billing_Continuity_Register_v1_0.xlsx** with two sheets: **Register** (one row per entity ad account) and **Incident and Check Log** (append-only).
2. Register columns, in order: Entity; Ad account ID; Marketplace; Console URL surface (advertising console / Seller Central path); Billing mode; Primary instrument (type, network, last 4); Primary expiry (MM/YYYY); Backup instrument (same fields); Backup expiry; Deduct-from-proceeds state (Y/N/N-A); Invoicing terms and due day (or N-A); Billing-admin role holder (role, never a name); Alert inbox routing address; Last successful payment (date, amount); Last P5 check stamp (date, role); Next lifecycle date (computed: earliest of expiries and due days); State (VERIFIED / STALE / FAILED / INCIDENT-OPEN).
3. Every value is copied from a console surface or a Finance confirmation, never remembered. A cell with no source stays empty and the row State cannot read VERIFIED while a required cell is empty.
4. Version the file per #1 governance conventions: the version increments on any schema change; row edits inside a version are stamped in the log sheet. The register owes a Definition Register entry under #1 (AM-8).
5. Storage: the governance library folder holding the #46 Access Register, because the two are audited by the same seat and reconciled against the same Matrix. Access to the register itself follows #46 rules.

P3. Configure primary and backup payment methods on each account

Time: 20 minutes per account plus Finance lead time for instrument issuance.

1. Obtain the instrument from Finance (boundary: Finance selects and owns it). Request in writing, naming the entity, the account ID, and whether it is primary or backup. The strongest backup is an instrument on a different issuer or bank than the primary, so one issuer-side freeze cannot kill both; the reasoning is recorded in the request.
2. In the entity's console: gear icon > **Billing** > payment settings surface > **Add payment method**. Enter the instrument; complete any bank or card verification challenge the console issues; confirm it appears in the method list.
3. Set the default: the method list marks one method as default; confirm the intended primary carries the default marker and the backup sits second. Where the console supports a backup designation explicitly, set it; where it does not, the backup's presence in the list is the control and P7 step 3 performs the switch manually at failure time.
4. Update both register rows (primary and backup fields, expiries, State re-read) and log the change with the Finance request reference.
5. Never remove the old primary in the same session that adds a new one; removal happens one P5 cycle after the new method's first successful charge appears in Payment history, so there is always one proven instrument on file.

P4. Monthly invoicing eligibility check and migration decision support

Time: 30 minutes per account plus Amazon case latency and Finance review. Decision owner: Finance with the CEO per Element 9; this SOP prepares the packet and executes the console side.

1. In the console Billing surface, look for an invoicing eligibility notice or invoicing tab. If none shows, open a case with Amazon ad support asking whether the account qualifies for monthly invoicing and what credit line applies. The credit line value is read from Amazon's response or the console; it is never assumed and never appears in this SOP as a figure.
2. Compute the comparison the decision needs: trailing 30-day ad spend for the account (T0 zone B weekly spend, summed across the trailing period from the account's own records) against the offered credit line. A line below trailing 30-day spend cannot carry the account alone and the card or debit method stays primary regardless of eligibility. The arithmetic convention is Worked Example 3.
3. Assemble the packet for Finance: eligibility state, line offered, trailing spend, due-day terms, and the register's current instrument state. Finance and the CEO decide; the decision and its date are logged.
4. On an approved migration: execute the console enrollment, record terms and due day in the register, and keep the card or debit method on file as the backup until two invoice cycles have paid clean, logged in the register.

P5. Weekly continuity check (inside the Monday cascade)

Time: 10-15 minutes for both accounts. This is the standing prevention control; it runs every week regardless of alarms.

1. Open the register; confirm the prior week's stamp exists (a missing prior stamp is logged as a skipped-check finding, F10 feeder).
2. Open each console Billing surface in turn. Compare the method list against the register row: type, last 4, default marker. Any mismatch: the console wins, the register corrects now, and the drift is logged with a cause (F7).
3. Read Payment history: confirm a successful charge or paid invoice since the prior check where the billing cycle produced one; record date and amount.
4. Read any banner state. A failed-charge or unpaid banner flips the row to FAILED and P7 starts now, inside the same session.
5. Read the Next lifecycle date column: where the earliest date falls inside the horizon the register computes (expiry month reached, or invoice due day inside this week), start P10 in this session.
6. Open the routed alert inbox; clear any billing notification into the log with its disposition.
7. Stamp the register (date, role) and set each row State: VERIFIED, or STALE where a console could not be opened (G8 clause: the stamp says which surface was not seen), or FAILED per step 4.
8. Route exceptions: FAILED to P7, lifecycle to P10, access failure to P11.

P6. Zero-delivery and unexplained-pause triage

Time: 15-30 minutes. Entry from any alarm-class trigger in Element 2. The tree runs before any lever anywhere: pulling a bid or budget lever on an undiagnosed delivery collapse is failure mode F8.

Decision tree (checked in order; first match wins):

1. **Billing failure.** Observable: the console Billing surface shows a failed-charge banner or unpaid balance, and campaign lists across the entity's entire account show a paused or not-delivering state with no operator pause of record. Scope test: the halt is entity-wide, not campaign-specific. Action: declare an incident (row State INCIDENT-OPEN, log entry with detection time) and run P7 now.
2. **Budget truncation.** Observable: specific campaigns show out-of-budget / in-budget signal per the v4.0 G3 read (in-budget below 70% of the day marks the campaign truncated), while the Billing surface is clean. Action: not billing; route to the owning SOP's budget lever per G3 and close this triage.
3. **Eligibility.** Observable: specific ads or SKUs flagged ineligible (v4.0 G4 class), Billing clean. Action: route to the owning SOP and the listing task per G4 same-day handling; close.
4. **Intended pause.** Observable: the paused state traces to a T6 entry or a #37 rule log line with matching date and target. Action: no incident; close with the trace reference.
5. **Platform incident.** Observable: none of 1-4 matches, both consoles behave anomalously, and Amazon's status surfaces or support confirm a platform issue. Action: hold, record start time, re-check on the same day, and log; no levers move.

If branch 4's evidence (T6 or the #37 log) is unavailable, the branch cannot clear and the ambiguity escalates to the PPC Lead the same day rather than closing (Interface I-5 consequence).

P7. Billing failure response (same day)

Time: 30-60 minutes of operator work, excluding bank or issuer latency. Human-mandatory checkpoints per Element 9 apply to steps 3 and 5.

1. From the Billing banner, identify the failing instrument and the failure text verbatim into the log (declined, expired, removed, invoice unpaid).
2. Transient-failure retry: where the console offers a retry or pay-now control against the existing method, execute it once and watch Payment history for the result. A second failure is treated as an instrument failure, not retried again.
3. Switch to backup: in payment settings, set the register's backup instrument as default (or pay the open balance with it where the console offers direct payment). This switch is human-confirmed by the PPC Lead before execution, and same-hour where reachable.
4. No backup on file (F3): escalate per P11 immediately; Finance provides an instrument same day; the exposure math of Element 6 is quoted in the escalation so the urgency is a number, not an adjective.
5. Confirm success: Payment history shows the charge or payment settled; the banner clears. Record fix time in the log. Where the balance settled but the banner persists past the same day, open an Amazon support case and record the case ID.
6. Hand to P8. The incident stays INCIDENT-OPEN until P8 passes; a settled charge with unverified campaign restoration is not a closed incident.

P8. Restoration verification

Time: 20 minutes same day, plus the next #38 T+1 report.

1. In the console, confirm campaign states have returned to their pre-incident enabled states account-wide. Amazon resumes billing-paused campaigns after payment settles; any campaign still paused past the same day is listed and routed to its owning SOP for state repair.
2. Confirm delivery resumed: spend accrues on the current day and the pacing read recovers against the day-of-week curve (the same G7 artifact that detected the failure now evidences the recovery).
3. At T+1, reconcile the #38 verification report and A2 deployment state against expectations; unexplained residual mismatches route per #38.
4. Flip the register row from INCIDENT-OPEN to VERIFIED, stamp the restoration time, and start P9.

P9. Post-incident reconciliation

Time: 30 minutes, same day as P8 or the next morning.

1. Write the closed incident record: detection time, cause branch from P6, remediation path, restoration time, and the delivery gap computed per the Element 6 conventions (expected spend by the day curve minus actual, and the foregone attributed sales that implies).
2. Flag the outage window for trend exclusion in the weekly audit: no v4.0 gate covers a non-event outage today (G10 is event-only), so the flag rides in the register log and is handed to the Monday audit by Interface I-7 until AM-3 lands. Rate reads inside the window are not used for verdicts.
3. Where any oversight-class term's rank slipped across the window, hand the window and the term list to #24 (Interface I-8) and stop at that boundary.
4. Feed Element 10: the first live incident after this SOP's adoption forces a version review; record what the incident showed about detection lag and response friction as candidate AM-1 figures.

P10. Instrument lifecycle handling

Time: 15 minutes per event plus Finance lead time.

1. Expiry approaching (register countdown surfaces it at P5): request the replacement from Finance in the same week, citing the expiry month. The replacement is added per P3 while the expiring instrument is still live, so the account never has fewer than two working instruments.
2. Check the #32 event calendar for armed or upcoming windows overlapping the expiry month (F9): an expiry inside an event window is handled in the week it is found, not queued, because an outage during an event multiplies the delivery gap by the event lift.
3. Entity banking changes (issuer change, account closure): Finance notifies per Interface I-2; both register rows re-verify per P1 steps 2-4 after the change lands.
4. Invoicing mode: the due day sits in the register; each P5 inside the due week confirms with Finance that the invoice is scheduled or paid; an unpaid invoice at due day is a FAILED state and runs P7 step 5's confirmation path with Finance executing the payment.

P11. Escalation and vacancy handling

Time: immediate; this procedure is a routing table, not a work session.

1. Billing-admin seat vacant or locked out: per the Authority Matrix standing vacancy rule, the seat's decisions revert to the PPC Lead and execution to the PPC Manager until filled; emergency access runs under #46's emergency access procedure, never by credential sharing.
2. Backup instrument absent or failed during an incident: Finance same day; unreachable Finance escalates to the CEO the same day, because the exposure is account-halting and the instruments are entity financial property only officers can issue.
3. Amazon-side failure (settled payment, campaigns still paused past same day): support case, case ID in the log, daily follow-up until cleared.
4. Every escalation entry names the blocked step, the time, and the exposure figure from the Element 6 math.

P12. Quarterly continuity drill

Time: 45 minutes per quarter, in the v4.0 V4 quarterly cadence class (Section 14 "Layer 9: Verification and Learning (V1-V8)"). Slot registration under #40 is AM-7.

1. Tabletop walk of P6 through P8 against the 2026-08-01 incident class: the operator narrates each branch observable and each console surface from memory, then verifies against the live consoles read-only.

- 2. Register audit: every cell re-verified against its console surface; drift handled per P5 step 2.
- 3. Backup viability: confirm the backup instrument is unexpired, still listed, and its issuer relationship still live per Finance; where the console has charged it at least once in the trailing period, note the proof; where it has never been charged, Finance confirms the instrument is active on the issuer side and the unproven state is recorded.
- 4. Access test: the billing-admin seat opens both Billing surfaces; the #46 view matches.
- 5. Drill stamp in the log. A missing drill stamp at quarter end is the F10 detection signal.

5. Verdict Mapping

Stated plainly per the first-build rule: the Master PPC Decision Criteria System v4.0 contains no billing thresholds, and the closed verdict vocabulary (v4.0, Section 13.1 "The Closed Verdict Vocabulary") contains no billing verdict. This SOP therefore issues zero verdicts from the closed vocabulary and quotes zero verdict strings. Its procedure outcomes (incident declared, incident closed, register states) are register vocabulary pending admission under the V3 amendment protocol (AM-2); they are never written as verdicts, and no keyword or campaign verdict is ever issued from a billing read.

The v4.0 rules this SOP does consume, each quoted with its section heading in the attached authority:

v4.0 rule	Section heading in v4.0	Use in this SOP
G7: pacing deviation >25% vs the day-of-week curve alerts same day	Section 5 "Layer 0: Gates (G1-G12). Nothing Proceeds Until These Pass"	The primary automatic detection artifact for a billing halt (Element 2; P6 entry; P8 recovery evidence)
G3: in-budget <70% of the day marks the campaign truncated	Section 5, same heading	P6 branch 2: distinguishes budget truncation from a billing halt
G4: eligibility flips alert same day and halt work on the target	Section 5, same heading	P6 branch 3: distinguishes eligibility events; sets the same-day lag class
G8: "the analysis states what it could not see"	Section 5, same heading	Element 3 and P5 step 7: honesty rule when a console or feed is unreadable
P8 (precedence): a data-quality failure beats every other consideration including urgency	Section 12 "Layer 7: Precedence and Conflict Resolution (P1-P10)"	P6 discipline: no lever moves on an undiagnosed collapse; the correct urgent action is establishing the true state same day
V4: quarterly cadence class	Section 14 "Layer 9: Verification and Learning (V1-V8)"	P12 drill cadence

Zero-local-thresholds statement. Every other numeral in this document is one of: an identity or date, a documented account fact quoted from the library (\$6,000-8,000/day envelope), a time estimate for the operator, or a labeled illustrative input inside Element 6. No numeral in this document functions as a decision threshold outside the v4.0 citations above. The number classes the component still needs (detection lag ceiling tighter than same-day, remediation clock, expiry lead time, invoice-confirmation lead, register staleness horizon) are amendment item AM-1.

6. Worked Examples

All three are illustrative and internally consistent; no live product economics spine is attached, so per the pack rule the examples use the standard fictional base (AOV \$80.00, contribution \$28.00, break-even ACOS 35.0%, Target 17.5%, Max Acceptable 26.3%) and an illustrative blended account ACOS of 25.0%, which sits under the fictional Max Acceptable line. Entity split is illustrative: Ecotero \$4,000/day, Inspirattek \$3,000/day, summing to \$7,000/day inside the documented \$6,000-8,000/day envelope.

WE-1 · Clean case: the weekly check catches an expiring card (opening line: illustrative, standard fictional base).
The 2026-08-24 P5 pass reads the Ecotero register row: primary card expiry 09/2026, next lifecycle date now inside the horizon. P10 fires in the same session: Finance issues the replacement that week, P3 adds it while the old card is live, and the old card is removed one cycle after the replacement's first clean charge. Exposure had the expiry been missed: a decline at the first September charge attempt pauses the Ecotero account. One 24-hour outage at \$4,000/day of delivery forgoes attributed sales of $4,000 / 0.25 = \$16,000$; at AOV \$80.00 that is $16,000 / 80 = 200$ orders, carrying contribution $200 \times 28.00 = \$5,600$; net of the \$4,000 ad spend that would have run, **\$1,600/day** of direct contribution is lost before any rank or flywheel effect, and every hour extends it at $\$16,000 / 24 = \$666.67/\text{hour}$ of attributed sales. Prevention cost: 15 minutes of P5 plus one Finance request.

WE-2 · Edge case: the 2026-08-01 failure class, detected, remediated, and reconciled (illustrative, standard fictional base).

Friday 05:40: the charge attempt against Inspiratek's retired card method fails; Amazon pauses the account's campaigns. The billing notification lands in a personal inbox no longer read (the F1 condition). 13:00: the daily pacing read computes expected spend by 13:00 at 40% of the \$3,000 day = **\$1,200**; actual spend is **\$120** (accrued before 05:40). Deviation = $(1,200 - 120) / 1,200 = 90.0\%$, past the v4.0 G7 25% line, and the same-day alert fires. P6 runs: the Inspiratek Billing surface shows the failed-charge banner and the halt is entity-wide with no T6 or #37 trace, so branch 1 matches and the incident opens at 13:20. P7: the retry against the dead method is skipped (the method is retired, not transient); the register's backup card is set default at 14:10, human-confirmed; Payment history shows the balance settled at 14:25; the banner clears. P8: campaigns re-enter delivery through the afternoon; the day closes at actual spend **\$1,920** vs the \$3,000 plan = **64.0%** of plan. P9 arithmetic: delivery gap $3,000 - 1,920 = \$1,080$; foregone attributed sales $1,080 / 0.25 = \$4,320$; orders $4,320 / 80 = 54$; contribution $54 \times 28.00 = \$1,512$; net of the unspent \$1,080, direct contribution lost = **\$432** for an 8.5-hour outage, plus unquantified rank exposure handed to #24 review (no oversight term slipped past tolerance in this instance, so #24 does not open). The outage window is flagged for trend exclusion; the week's rate reads on Inspiratek carry the flag; the alert-routing cell in the register is corrected to the role inbox, closing the F1 cause. Incident closed 15:05 with detection lag 7h40m recorded as a candidate AM-1 figure.

WE-3 · Migration read: invoicing eligibility does not clear the line test (illustrative, standard fictional base).

P4 on Ecotero: the console confirms monthly invoicing eligibility and Amazon's response names a credit line of **\$40,000** (illustrative; the live value is always read, never assumed). Trailing 30-day spend = $4,000 \times 30 = \$120,000$. The comparison: $40,000 - 120,000 = -\$80,000$; the line covers $40,000 / 120,000 = 33.3\%$ of a billing month, so invoicing cannot carry the account alone and the charge method stays primary. The packet goes to Finance with that arithmetic; the logged decision is defer, re-check at the next eligibility review or when Amazon raises the line. The lesson mirrors the library's economics discipline: eligibility is not capacity, and the migration decision is a computed comparison, not a status upgrade.

7. Failure Modes and Escalation

Failure	Detection signal	Response
F1. Silent decline: notification lands unrouted	G7 pacing alert with no matching inbox entry; banner found only at P6	P6 then P7; the register alert-routing cell corrects to a role inbox the same day. Motivating incident: the 2026-08-01 program-wide end of the legacy card method, four days before this SOP existed.
F2. Wrong entity remediated	Banner persists on the failed account; Payment history unchanged after the supposed fix	Re-run P7 on the correct account; the register keys every row by ad account ID and P7 step 1 quotes the ID before any change.
F3. No backup instrument on file	P5 reads an empty backup cell; or P7 step 3 finds nothing to switch to	P3 within the same week on the P5 path; P11 same-day Finance escalation on the incident path, with the Element 6 exposure figure quoted.
F4. Access lockout at failure time	Billing page will not open for the seat; #46 view shows vacancy or a dead credential	P11 step 1: vacancy reversion per the Matrix standing rule; #46 emergency access; never credential sharing.
F5. Invoice unpaid at due day (invoicing mode)	Register due-day check inside P5 finds no Finance payment confirmation	Finance executes payment same day; State FAILED until Payment history shows it settled; repeated occurrences route the invoicing decision back through P4.
F6. Campaigns not restored after settlement	P8 step 1 list; #38 T+1 mismatch rows	Owning SOPs repair states; past same day, support case per P11 step 3; the incident does not close until P8 passes.
F7. Register drift vs console	P5 step 2 compare mismatch; quarterly drill audit	The console wins for billing state; the register corrects with a logged cause. This is the deliberate inverse of the program's workbook-is-truth rule: billing truth lives only on Amazon's surface.
F8. Misattribution: billing halt read as performance collapse	T6 lever entries dated inside an outage window; rate verdicts written on outage-week reads	Revert the lever per the owning SOP; apply the trend-exclusion flag; the P6 tree is re-taught: it runs before any lever, always.
F9. Expiry inside an armed event window	P10 step 2 overlap check of register lifecycle dates vs the #32 calendar	Replacement lands before the window opens; the overlap and its resolution are logged; event exposure noted because an in-event outage forgoes event-lift sales, not baseline sales.
F10. Drill skipped; backup dead when needed	Missing quarterly drill stamp; P7 backup switch fails	P12 re-arms immediately; two live instruments per account restored per P3; the skipped-drill cause is named in the log.

Escalation standard: the same failure mode twice in consecutive quarters on the same account escalates to the PPC Lead with the log history; anything touching a payment instrument or an incident declaration sits in the human-mandatory tier of Element 9 without exception.

8. Outputs and Artifacts

Artifact	Storage location	Retention	Downstream consumer
Billing Continuity Register (Register sheet)	Billing_Continuity_Register_v1_0.xlsx in the governance library folder holding the #46 Access Register	Current version live; superseded versions retained per #1 supersession conventions	P5-P12 of this SOP; #46 on demand (the reciprocal of its filtered view); the quarterly drill
Incident and Check Log (append-only sheet)	Same workbook	Permanent; never edited, only appended	The Monday audit (trend-exclusion flags, I-7); #24 (rank-affected windows, I-8); Element 10 reviews; #6 scoring context where an outage explains a missed prediction
Weekly check stamp	Register header + log entry	With the register	#4 cadence conformance; the F10 detection read
Incident record (closed)	Log sheet, one entry per incident	Permanent	AM-1 evidence base for the threshold owner; the P12 drill scenario library
Escalation entries	Log sheet	Permanent	PPC Lead; Matrix re-issue evidence when AM-5 lands

9. Skill-Conversion Block

Block	Specification
Input bindings	Billing Continuity Register fields (all P2 columns, by name); console Billing surface reads (method list, default marker, Payment history last entry, banner text): a manual surface with no feed in the Raw Pull Pack, so the agent's binding is the register plus operator-entered console captures until AM-6 defines a field group; A2 deployment state and the #38 T+1 report; T0 daily pacing read (the G7 artifact); T6 Decision Log; #37 rule log; #46 billing-admin filtered view; the #32 event calendar for the F9 overlap check.
Deterministic logic	Register-vs-console field comparison (exact string and last-4 match); Next lifecycle date = earliest of expiry and due-day dates; G7 deviation arithmetic consumed from upstream, never recomputed; the P6 tree encoded as ordered branch checks on the named observables; WE-1 exposure arithmetic as the standard escalation figure generator. The skill executes mappings and never computes a threshold; it version-pins v4.0 per the V6 sync rule.
Human checkpoints	The Authority Matrix v2.0 carries no #43 row (AM-5). Interim, per the Matrix standing vacancy rule and the 10-80-10 method (#7): human-mandatory, always : adding, removing, or switching any payment method (PPC Lead confirms; Finance supplies); incident declaration and incident close (PPC Lead); the P4 migration decision (Finance with the CEO); any escalation past Finance (CEO). AI-executable with audit : register upkeep drafts, lifecycle countdown alarms, P6 evidence packets, log drafting, drill scheduling.
Cadence	Weekly P5 inside the Monday cascade; same-day alarm handling per Element 2 lags; quarterly P12 in the V4 quarterly class; P1 re-audit on any entity-level account event.
Outputs	Drafted register rows and stamps queued for confirmation; lifecycle and drift alarms with evidence lines (row, surface, observed vs registered value); P6 triage packets with branch observables filled; drafted incident and escalation log entries carrying the exposure figure.

10. Version Governance

Owner: PPC Lead. Registered against #1 on publication. Component-specific review triggers, each forcing a dated re-read of this SOP:

- Any Amazon change to advertising payment surfaces, charge sequencing, or invoicing terms observed at P5 or announced (the 2026-08-01 method termination is the class instance: a platform billing change is a version trigger here the way a v4.0 increment is a trigger in SOP-12).
- Any entity banking or instrument-issuer change from Finance (I-2).
- Authority Matrix re-issue touching the billing-admin, Finance, or CEO escalation roles, and the landing of AM-5, which re-homes Element 9's interim rights.
- The first live incident after adoption, and every incident thereafter: P9 step 4 feeds this review with measured detection and response figures.
- Any AM-1 through AM-9 item landing in v4.1 or the named registers, at which point the corresponding placeholder language here is

replaced by citation.

6. #40 landing (due 2026-09-18), which takes over the quarterly drill slot registration.

11. Operator Ramp

The Authority Matrix v2.0 names no #43 decision row, so this ramp is built from the Matrix's role definitions and standing vacancy rule plus this SOP's own procedures; the checkpoint holder throughout is the PPC Lead (the role every unassigned D reverts to under the Matrix's standing rules). The competences below are the AM-5 row material.

Week 1: observation and artifact familiarity

- Reproduce both register rows from the live consoles read-only, alongside the holder, without touching a setting: every P2 field located on its console surface and named aloud.
- Walk the P6 tree on paper against three historical paused-state cases pulled from T6, classifying each into its branch from the recorded observables.
- Name every Element 12 interface, its artifact, and its non-arrival consequence from memory.

Week 2: supervised execution, checkpoint holder reviewing

- Run the full P5 pass on both accounts with the PPC Lead reviewing the stamp and every exception routing before it is filed.
- Stage one P10 lifecycle action end to end (Finance request drafted, P3 steps rehearsed) under review.
- Draft a complete incident log entry from the WE-2 scenario, including the exposure arithmetic, reviewed line by line.

Week 4: unsupervised execution, checkpoint holder auditing

- Run P5 unsupervised for two consecutive Mondays; the PPC Lead audits the stamps and exception routing after the fact.
- Lead one P12 tabletop as the narrator, with the holder playing Finance and Amazon support.
- Hold the same-day alarm response for one deployment day, including a seeded false alarm that must exit the P6 tree at branch 2 or 4 without an incident declaration.

Live-defense questions (reasoning, never threshold recall)

1. Why does the P6 tree run before any lever, and what does the v4.0 precedence layer say about urgency on an undiagnosed state?
2. Everywhere else in the program the workbook is the source of truth and the console is transport. Why does this SOP invert that for billing state, and what failure does the inversion prevent?
3. Why is a backup instrument on a different issuer a stronger control than a second card from the same bank?
4. An expiry date falls inside an armed event window. What changes about its urgency, and whose calendar proves it?
5. A billing outage polluted a week of rate reads. No v4.0 gate covers it. What do you do with the week's verdicts and where is the gap logged?
6. Amazon offers monthly invoicing with a line below trailing 30-day spend. Why does eligibility not retire the card rows, and what is the comparison that decides it?

12. Interface Contracts

Built from the Cross-Reference Ledger's #43 and #46 rows and the Data Architecture artifact definitions. Every row states what happens when the handoff does not arrive, because that clause is the one the corpus has been missing.

ID	Direction	Sending owner → receiving owner	Artifact	Timing	Non-arrival consequence
I-1	Up	#46 (Access owner) → #43 operator	Billing-admin filtered Access Register view	On demand; at every org change	Seat state unverifiable: P5 runs on console observation only, the stamp records the gap per the G8 clause, and the access question escalates to the PPC Lead.
I-2	Up	Finance / entity officers → #43 operator	Payment instruments, replacements, invoicing decisions	Before the expiry month; same day on incident	P7 cannot complete: CEO escalation same day per P11 with the Element 6 exposure figure; the account runs on a single instrument, logged as an open F3 condition.
I-3	Up	Amazon (external) → routed alert inbox	Billing notifications (failed charge, expiry, invoice)	Event-driven	Detection falls back to the G7 pacing artifact and the #38 report; F1 is logged and the routing cell is repaired the same day it is found.
I-	Up	#38 → #43	T+1 verification report; A2	T+1 after	P6 branches 2-4 lose their evidence: triage runs on direct

4		operator	deployment state	deploys; Monday refresh	console state, the manifest gap is recorded, and no branch-4 closure is allowed on absence of evidence.
I-5	Up	#37 → #43 operator	Automation rule log (rule-driven pause trace)	Weekly reconcile; on demand in triage	Branch 4 cannot clear: ambiguous pauses escalate to the PPC Lead the same day instead of closing as intended actions.
I-6	Down	#43 operator → every operating SOP (12-38)	Incident broadcast: INCIDENT-OPEN freezes new deploys in the affected account until P8 passes	Same day as declaration	Staged sets deploy into a paused account: #38 T+1 returns account-wide mismatches, operator time burns on false F10-class investigation, and the F8 misattribution risk opens.
I-7	Down	#43 operator → Monday audit (#36 by absorption)	Trend-exclusion flag for the outage window	Before the next Monday pass	Outage-week rates enter trend verdicts: wrong-direction V5 scores accumulate against innocent rules and the F8 class recurs at audit level.
I-8	Down	#43 operator → #24	Outage window + rank-affected oversight terms	Within the P9 session	Recovery never opens: rank damage compounds unrouted and later surfaces as a misdiagnosed cold-start case.
I-9	Down	#43 operator → #1	Register Definition Register entry; version notes	At each register version	The register is an unregistered artifact: the same governance gap #46 logged for its Access Register repeats, and supersession becomes unauditable.
I-10	Down	#43 (this document) → #44	Element 11 ramp content	When #44 builds (due 2026-09-25)	Operator certification omits the one SOP whose failure halts every other; the gap is raised at the #44 build session.

Closing: v4.1 and Register Amendment List (AM-1 to AM-9)

- AM-1.** v4.0 contains no billing continuity thresholds. Needed number classes for the threshold owner: detection lag ceiling tighter than same-day for an entity-wide halt (WE-2 measured 7h40m as first evidence); remediation clock from declaration to backup switch; expiry lead time in days; invoice-confirmation lead before due day; register staleness horizon beyond the weekly stamp. Until v4.1, the binding standard on alarms is the v4.0 same-day class.
- AM-2.** Register state vocabulary (VERIFIED / STALE / FAILED / INCIDENT-OPEN) needs formal admission under the V3 amendment protocol as a #43-scope state list, mirroring the access-state vocabulary item #46 logged.
- AM-3.** No v4.0 gate excludes non-event outage windows from trend verdicts; G10 covers events only. Proposed: an outage-exclusion clause of the G10 pattern keyed to the incident log.
- AM-4.** The T5 Product Log closed event-type list (8 types, Data Architecture Section 9) carries no billing-outage type; one is owed so outage windows appear on the product timeline consumed by attribution checks.
- AM-5.** The Authority Matrix v2.0 carries no #43 row. Owed cells: billing state checks, default-method switch, incident declare and close, migration decisions, escalation past Finance. Element 9's interim assignments are the candidate row.
- AM-6.** No #39 manifest field group covers billing state; the console remains a manual read outside the Raw Pull Pack. Owed: a billing-state field group or a documented standing exception.
- AM-7.** #4 names no billing-check slot in the Monday cascade and the quarterly drill has no calendar home until #40 lands (due 2026-09-18).
- AM-8.** The Billing Continuity Register owes a Definition Register entry under #1.
- AM-9.** The Ledger #43 row's NOT BUILT / DUE 2026-07-31 status is superseded by this build; the returned row accompanies this document.

Pre-logged items not re-opened here: the closed-vocabulary count discrepancy (18/25/26) already logged by the #41, #46, and #17/18/19 builds, and the gate-numbering item (Data Architecture T5 labels its trend-exclusion flag with a gate ID that v4.0 assigns to MKL hygiene) already carried as the #17/18/19 build's C9 item.

Companions: Master PPC Decision Criteria System v4.0 (the sole threshold authority) · PPC Cross-Reference Ledger (#43, #46, #37, #38 rows) · PPC Authority Matrix v2.0 (standing rules; AM-5 pending) · #46 Access and Permissions (the seat) · #38 Bulk-File Deployment Mechanics (T+1 evidence) · Master PPC Data Architecture v1.0 (T0 pacing, T6, T7) · PPC Economics Worked Example Set v1.0 (arithmetic conventions). Inspiratek & Ecotero LLC · PPC Department · SOP-43 v1.0 · Confidential.